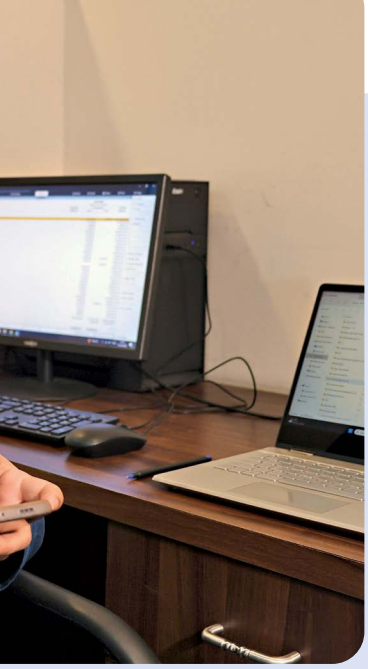


RANJAN RAHI

FARAH NAAZ, 23

Final year student of Chartered Accountancy

Lok Sabha constituency: Patna Sahib, Bihar

Top three demands: Job creation, communal harmony and curbing inflation

What will influence her vote: Unemployment, state of democracy

"Reservation for women in politics may not empower them, those from political families may benefit more"

sembly in 2020. Dismissing the portrayal of the 2024 general election as a 'Narendra Modi vs Rahul Gandhi' showdown, she terms it a narrative aimed at diverting attention from core issues such as unemployment, communal harmony, the perceived erosion of democratic institutions in the country and the importance of safeguarding freedom of speech and expression. The Ram temple inauguration in Ayodhya in January may influence the vote of some, she concedes, but doubts it will impact the decision of the majority. And refraining from endorsing any single leader, she both expresses her confidence in the integrity of Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal—arrested by the Enforcement Directorate in a liquor scam case—and voices appreciation for PM Modi's initiatives for a 'Viksit Bharat'. The Opposition INDIA bloc, though, she writes off as a temporary electoral alliance. ■

-Amitabh Srivastava

Eye on Party Vision

For the past decade, 30-year-old Gujarat resident Niravkumar Sanchaniya has not missed any opportunity to exercise his franchise and claims he tries to make an informed choice each time, studying the poll manifestos released by parties to understand their vision for society and country before casting his vote. Gujarat votes in a single phase on May 7 for the 2024 general election. Sanchaniya's behaviour as a voter is in keeping with his overall studious nature—he helped his carpenter father enrol for a fortnight-long entrepreneurship programme, enabling him to open his own ration shop five years ago. He himself has completed a special two-year certificate programme at IIM-Ahmedabad, which is conducted by IIMs for the Ministry of Skill Development. The programme includes a feild experience at a government department. As part of this, Sanchaniya became a part of the Bharuch collector's initiative to revive the indigenous Sujani handicraft by training artisans in the dying textile tradition. ■

-Jumana Shah

NIRAVKUMAR SANCHANIYA, 29

Electrical engineer

Lok Sabha constituency: Kheda, Gujarat

What will influence his vote : Inflation, unemployment, decentralisation of development and party manifesto

"We need to rethink industrialisation, generate more employment, ensure better skilling of people"

KHUSHAL MAKHIJA, 24

Student, Maulana Azad Institute of Dental Sciences

Lok Sabha constituency: Chandni Chowk, Delhi

Top 3 demands: Education, fairer taxes, development

What will influence his vote: The mandates of parties towards identity politics

Narendra] Modi, in terms of political experience and performance, I would say Modi has the upper edge. However, it should be BJP versus Congress. And if that is the scenario, I would pick the Congress because I am against any kind of identity/religious politics". He adds, however, that his opinion is based on news coverage and word-of-mouth and before voting, he will do evidence-based study. ■

-Sonali Acharjee

